

Fallen into a Rabbit Hole

談國際學生面對留學困境及解套方式

Feb. 25, 2024

郭思廷

胡宛琳

Our motivations and goals

- For those who are already abroad/onboard (in the rabbit hole)
- Uncover the survival bias
- Find proper **resources** to protect and help yourself
- **TL;DR: Your wellbeings are what really matter!**



Some statistics: The UC system by 2023

UC doctoral persistence and completion rates by entry cohorts

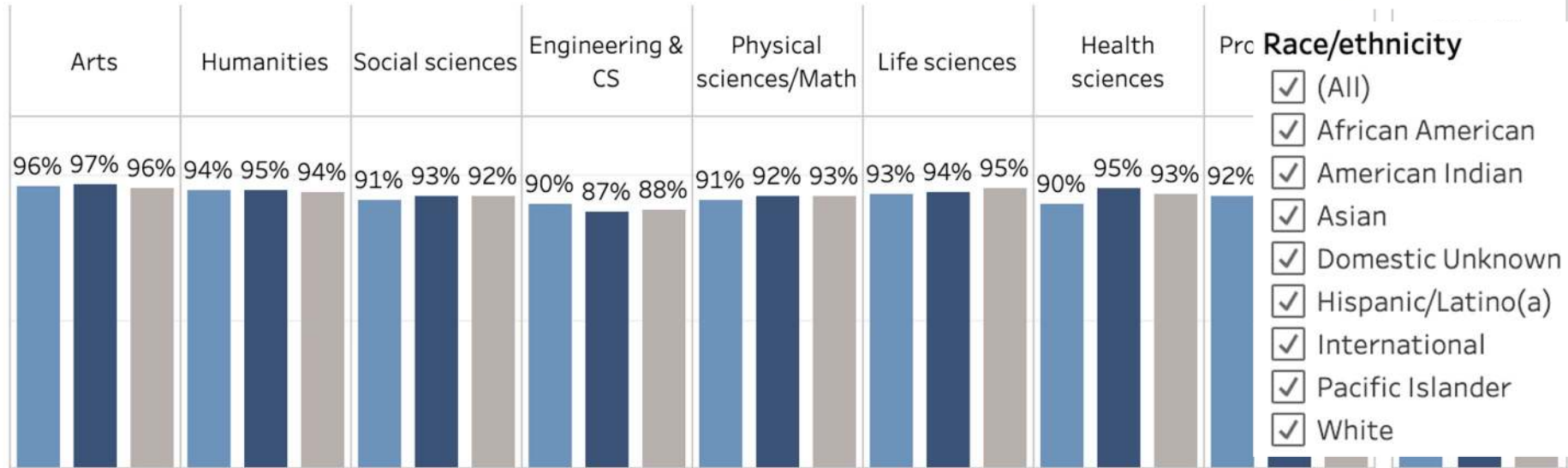
2 year retention rate by discipline - All campus

Entering cohorts

2007 - 2009

2010 - 2012

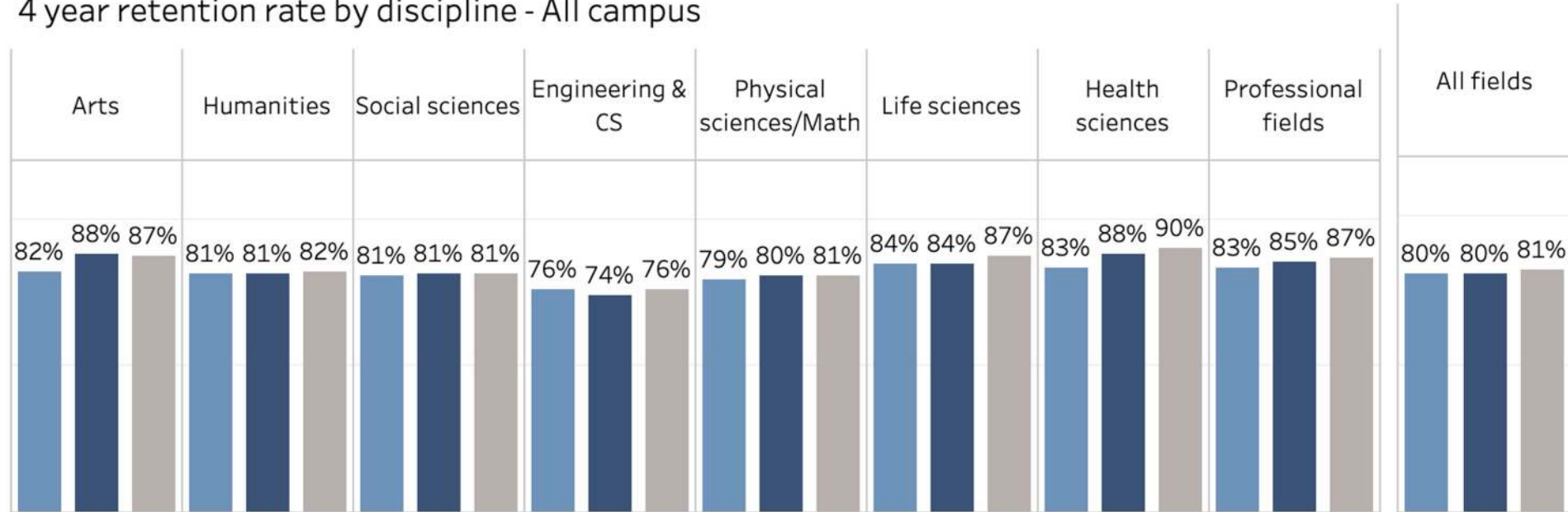
2013 - 2014



Some statistics: The UC system by 2023

UC doctoral persistence and completion rates by entry cohorts

4 year retention rate by discipline - All campus

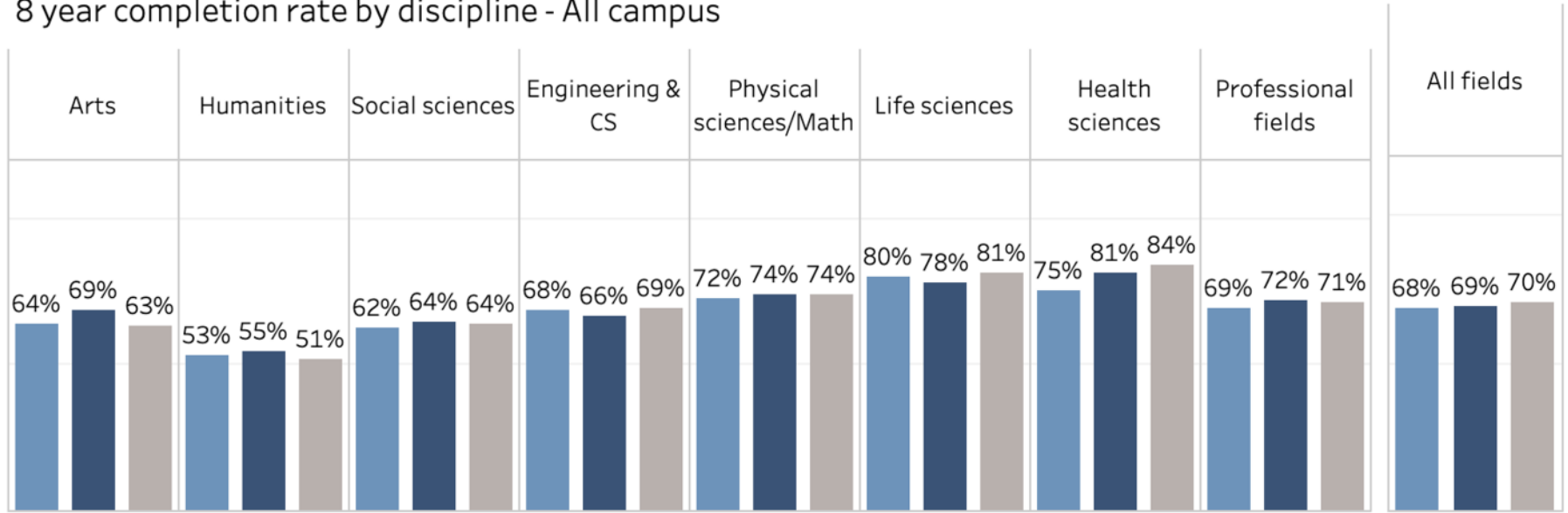


<https://www.universityofcalifornia.edu/about-us/information-center/doctoral-rates>

Some statistics: The UC system by 2023

UC doctoral persistence and completion rates by entry cohorts

8 year completion rate by discipline - All campus



Some statistics: The UC system by 2023

UC doctoral persistence and completion rates by entry cohorts

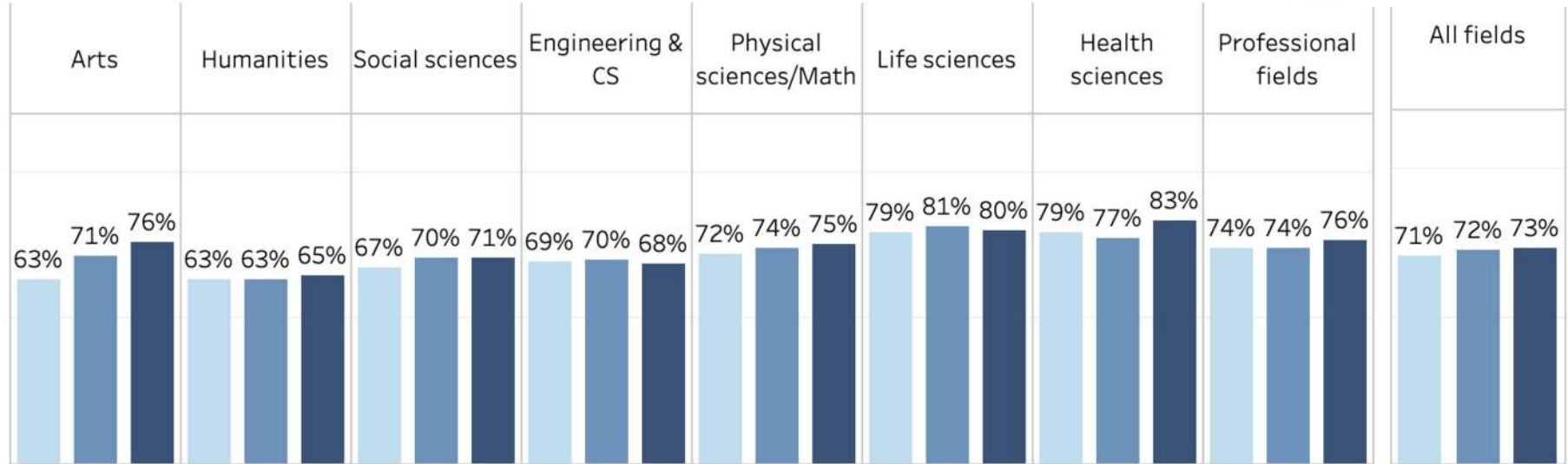
10 year completion rate by discipline - All campus

Entering cohorts

2004 - 2006

2007 - 2009

2010 - 2012



Some statistics - PTT forum

【板主:axisaxes】				【板主:reluctant/Zing119】				【博士班甘苦談】				系列《PhD》
[←]離開 [→]閱讀 [Ctrl-P]發表文章 [d]刪除 [z]精華區 [i]看板資訊/設定 [h]說明				[←]離開 [→]閱讀 [Ctrl-P]發表文章 [d]刪除 [z]精華區 [i]看板資訊/設定 [h]說明				[←]離開 [→]閱讀 [Ctrl-P]發表文章 [d]刪除 [z]精華區 [i]看板資訊/設定 [h]說明				
編號	日期	作者	人氣	編號	日期	作者	人氣	文章	標題	人氣	文章	標題
1	1312/06	Dani		28	6 9/09	kusobike		R: [問題]	可否放棄國際研討會口頭發表			
2	24 4/29	Godf		29	m29 5/15	muto52		□ [心得]	一個很大的決定: 放棄美國博士班			
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4	m 5 4/30	snow		31	m17 5/24	onehundred		R: [心得]	一個很大的決定: 放棄美國博士班			
5	m12 4/30	UYC		32	m16 5/26	callisto2		R: [心得]	一個很大的決定: 放棄美國博士班			
6	1 4/30	wood		33	12 6/05	nicko		□ [問題]	繼續與放棄之間的猶豫不決...			
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8	10 5/04	lala		35	7 8/12	nvfp		R: [問題]	繼續與放棄之間的猶豫不決...			
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11	2 5/06	oneh		38	m3710/13	agill		R: [心得]	我的放棄心得			
12	2510/08	chil		39	m1510/14	audition		R: [心得]	我的放棄心得			
				40	m 110/15	darthv		R: [心得]	我的放棄心得			
				41	m 410/18	blackacre		R: [心得]	我的放棄心得			
				42	21 4/02	chin803		□ [問題]	在放棄唸博士班的想法中猶豫			
				43	2 4/03	jamtu		R: [問題]	在放棄唸博士班的想法中猶豫			
				44	4/04	lin214		R: [問題]	在放棄唸博士班的想法中猶豫			
				45	9 4/15	ChallengerII		R: [問題]	在放棄唸博士班的想法中猶豫			
				46	2411/29	peter0816		□ [問題]	博班入學後想放棄了			
				47	12/08	saltlake		R: [問題]	博班入學後想放棄了			

關鍵詞：放棄

Outline

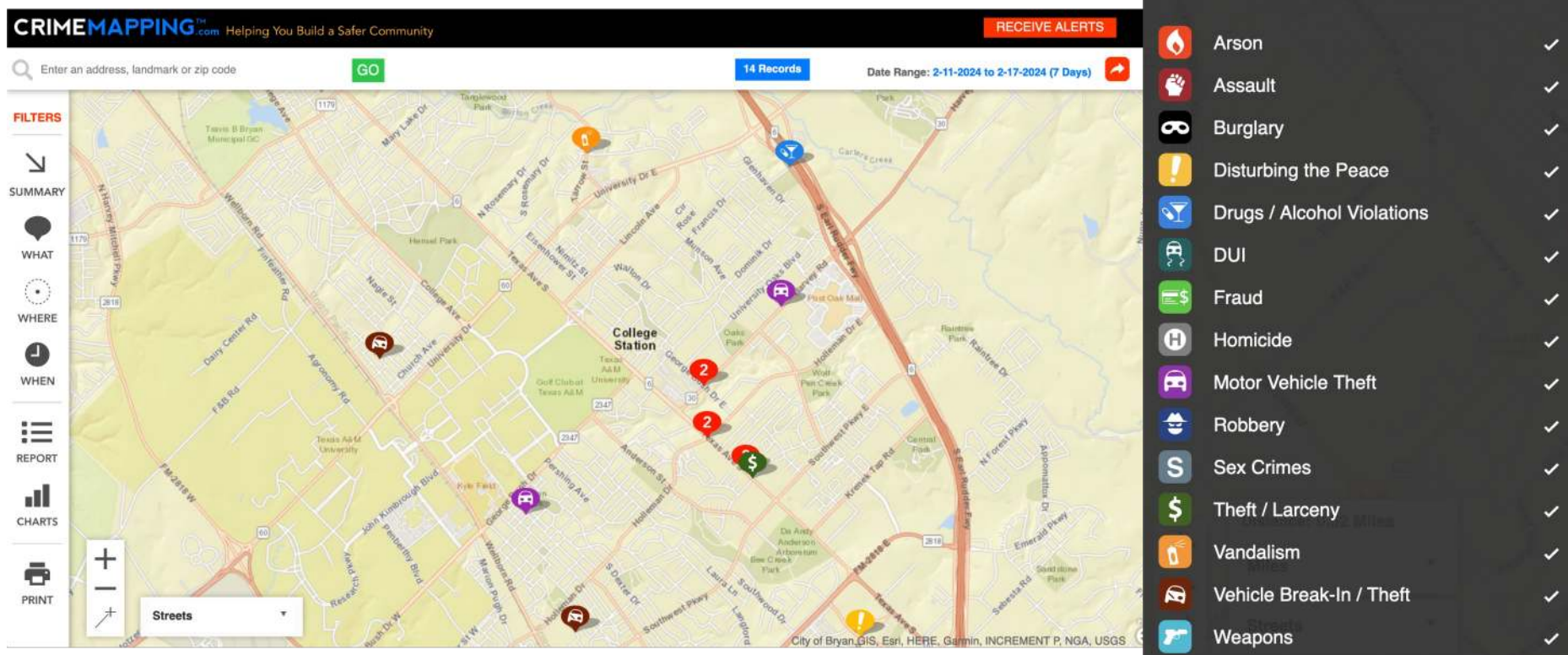
- General challenges (郭思廷)
 - Cultural shock
 - Financial problems
 - Coursework
 - Supporting system
 - Overall wellbeings
- Specific challenges for grad students (胡宛琳)
 - Keep your progress on track
 - Relationships between you and your advisor(s)/colleagues
 - Writing, presentation, or transferable skills
 - Teaching obligations or other part-time jobs

General - Cultural shock

- What is your cultural background?
 - What do you **care** about in your daily life when you are/were in TW?
 - How **comfortable** are you to blend into a different culture?
- Language-related issues
 - Blend the language into your daily life
- Social distances
 - Asian group
 - Non-asian group
 - Commitment and anticipation
- Showcasing yourself (浮誇係數)
 - Cover letter
 - Personal statements
 - Networking

General - Cultural shock

- CrimeMapping <https://www.crimemapping.com/map/agency/491>



General - Cultural shock

- Definition of a discrimination

What is discrimination?

Discrimination is the **unfair or prejudicial treatment** of people and groups based on characteristics such as **race, gender, age, or sexual orientation**. That's the simple answer. But explaining why it happens is more complicated.

Diversity And Inclusion

<https://www.apa.org/topics/racism-bias-discrimination/types-stress>

Where Does DEI Go from Here?

Fostering four freedoms can benefit employees and companies alike. by
Laura Morgan Roberts

September 14, 2023

The Big Idea Series / **The Next Phase of DEI**

01

Where Does DEI Go from Here?

02

Overcoming Today's DEI Leadership Challenges

03

Do You Feel Free at Work?

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI)
An article from Harvard Business Review

<https://dub.sh/biTbQPC>

General - Cultural shock

- Discrimination(s): racial, sexual, etc.

**Title IX at Texas A&M**
Department of Civil Rights & Equity Investigations

Make a Report

Understand the Process

Education & Training

If the Alleged Offender is a:	Then the Official Contact is:
Student	Student Affairs
Student Employee	Student Affairs
Graduate Student or Postdoctoral Student working in academic affairs	Faculty Affairs *
Graduate Student or Postdoctoral Students working in other areas	Civil Rights & Equity Investigations *
Non-Faculty Employee	Civil Rights & Equity Investigations *
Faculty	Faculty Affairs *

General - Financial problems

- Living/dining expenses

Semester
☒ Fall 2022 or Spring 2023 ☐ Summer 2023 ☐ Fall 2023 or Spring 2024

College or School

Geosciences

Hours
 12

Resident Tuition and Required Fees
\$5,175.68

Non-Resident Tuition and Required Fees
\$11,529.80

Program Fees	
Online Master of Geoscience Program	\$445/hr for residents, \$259/hr for non-residents

Information about the total cost of attendance is available from [Aggie One Stop](#)

General - Financial problems

- Living/dining expenses

The estimated cost to attend Texas A&M for 2021-2022 is approximately \$31,476 for in-state residents, which includes tuition and fees, housing & food, books, transportation, and miscellaneous expenses.

Texas A&M offers over \$933 million in financial assistance each year, which means many students' out-of-pocket costs are much lower than the published cost of attendance. In fact, last year a student with a family income under \$40,000 had an average out-of-pocket cost of about \$11,135, and a student with a family income between \$40,000 and \$80,000 had an average out-of-pocket cost of about \$13,317.

Applying for financial assistance may provide the additional resources necessary to cover out-of-pocket costs.

General - Financial problems

- Short-term financial aids

Short-Term Loan

I need money to help me pay rent, buy food, books or other educational related expenses (including Aggie Rings).

Short-Term Loans (STL) must be repaid in a one to twelve-month period.

Apply for an STL

I need temporary help with paying tuition and fees

The Emergency Tuition and Fees Loan (ETFL) is available for this purpose.

Apply for an ETFL

<https://aggie.tamu.edu/financial-aid/types-of-aid/additional-aid-opportunities/emergency-aid>

SCHOLARSHIPS AND FINANCIAL AID

- Types of Aid

+ Grants

+ Scholarships

+ Loans

Student Employment

+ Tuition Waivers and Exemptions

- Additional Aid Opportunities

Emergency Aid

Emergency Relief Funds & COVID-19
Guidance

Student-Athletes

+ Apply for Aid

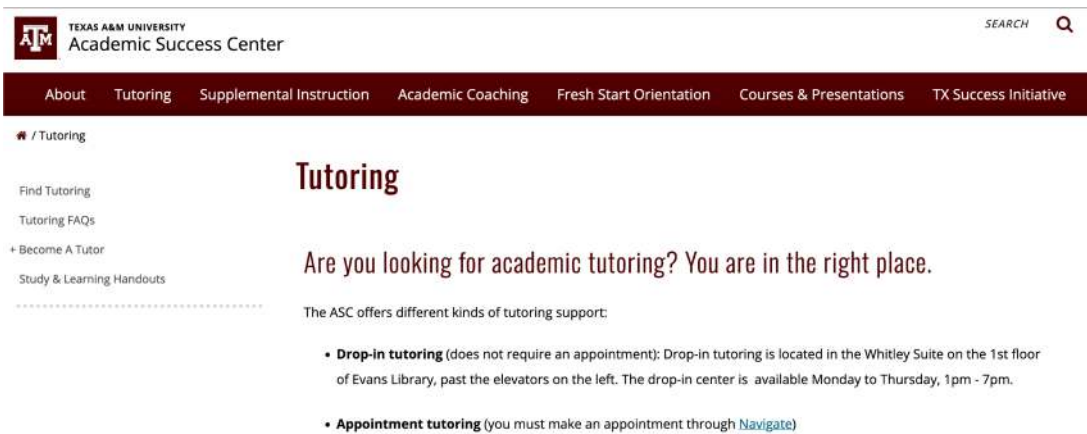
+ Military Education Benefits

General - Coursework

You don't have to fight alone!

- Falling behind
 - Office hours
 - Tutoring
 - Study groups

- Language-related issues
 - University Writing Center (UWC)



The screenshot shows the Texas A&M University Academic Success Center website. The header includes the university logo and name, a search bar, and a navigation menu with links: About, Tutoring, Supplemental Instruction, Academic Coaching, Fresh Start Orientation, Courses & Presentations, and TX Success Initiative. The main content area is titled "Tutoring" and features a sidebar with links: Find Tutoring, Tutoring FAQs, Become A Tutor, and Study & Learning Handouts. The main text area says "Are you looking for academic tutoring? You are in the right place." and lists two types of tutoring: Drop-in tutoring (no appointment, located in the Whitley Suite) and Appointment tutoring (requires an appointment through Navigate).

TEXAS A&M UNIVERSITY
Academic Success Center

SEARCH

About Tutoring Supplemental Instruction Academic Coaching Fresh Start Orientation Courses & Presentations TX Success Initiative

/ Tutoring

Find Tutoring
Tutoring FAQs
+ Become A Tutor
Study & Learning Handouts

Tutoring

Are you looking for academic tutoring? You are in the right place.

The ASC offers different kinds of tutoring support:

- **Drop-in tutoring** (does not require an appointment): Drop-in tutoring is located in the Whitley Suite on the 1st floor of Evans Library, past the elevators on the left. The drop-in center is available Monday to Thursday, 1pm - 7pm.
- **Appointment tutoring** (you must make an appointment through [Navigate](#))



The screenshot shows the Texas A&M University University Writing Center website. The header includes the university logo and name, a search bar, and a navigation menu with links: About Us, Undergrads, Grads, English Learners, and Faculty & Advisors. The main content area is titled "UNDERGRADS" and features three sections: MAKE AN APPOINTMENT, THE AGGIE CREATIVE COLLECTIVE & C COURSES (with a link to Aggie Creative Collective Application), and WRITING & SPEAKING GUIDES.

TEXAS A&M UNIVERSITY
University Writing Center

SEARCH

About Us Undergrads Grads English Learners Faculty & Advisors

UNDERGRADS

MAKE AN APPOINTMENT

THE AGGIE CREATIVE COLLECTIVE & C COURSES
Aggie Creative Collective Application

WRITING & SPEAKING GUIDES

General - Supporting system

- Family
 - Friendships
 - Relationships
-
- Do you have mutual goals?
 - Respect each other
 - Recognize the uncertainties
 - Appreciate the companionship



<https://weirdo.in/understanding-long-distance-relationships/>

General - Overall wellbeings

- Medical system in the US
 - Health insurance
(in network or not?)
 - Clinic
 - Urgent Care
 - Emergency Room (ER)
- Counseling services on-campus and off-campus



If you would like to do more to help others...

- Training sessions held by University counseling center
 - QPR (Question, Persuade, Refer) training session
 - Gatekeeper for those in crisis
 - LGBTQ+ Allies



QPR Question. Persuade. Refer.

Anyone can help save a life

FREE online suicide prevention training

Every day eight Australians die by suicide

Chances are you're in a position to help. Make sure you know what to do.

Only takes 60 minutes

\$0 FREE

Licenses remain active for 3 years

Certificate of completion

Over 2.5m people trained worldwide

18+ For people 18 years and over

AGGIE PRIDE



LGBTQ NETWORK

This Constituent Network will serve as a place for LGBTQ Aggies and Aggie allies to build connections with one another and strengthen their ties to the university. The network will work with Texas A&M's LGBTQ+ Pride Center, LGBTQ Professional Network, and Office for Diversity.

Our motivations and goals

- For those who are already abroad/onboard (in the rabbit hole)
- Uncover the survival bias
- Find proper **resources** to protect and help yourself
- **Your wellbeings are what really matter!**

下半場 Specific challenges for grad students
請登入

<https://meet.google.com/ose-vitk-gkt>



Specific challenges for grad students

1. Keep your progress on track
2. Relationships between you and your advisor(s)/colleagues
3. Writing, presentation, or transferable skills
4. Teaching obligations or other part-time jobs

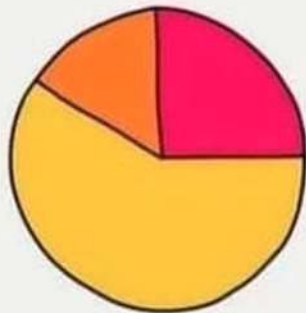
Specific challenges for grad students

- 1. Keep your progress on track**
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4. Teaching obligations or other part-time jobs

PhD life

@labducks

What people think



- Work
- Social
- Sleep

The reality



- Lab
- Reading
- Writing
- Analysis
- Teaching
- "that's broken"
- Planning
- Worrying
- "More reading"
- "Shit that didn't work"
- crying
- deciding to quit
- deciding not to quit
- fear
- "I'll use Dr on my mail"

source: PhD help

Grad life - 1. Keep your progress on track

- Some examples:
Most should be available on campus or in your department (semester or annual evaluations)
- Time management:
If you are working 20+ hrs/week in addition to your own research...

	Expected Completion Date/Semester
Select Graduate Committee Chair/PI	End of third semester (Fall 2020)
BIMS Curricular Track Selection	End of third semester (Fall 2020)
Establishment of Graduate Committee	End of third long semester (Spring 2021)
Staff Academic Advising	Once an academic year.
Annual Graduate Committee Meeting	Once an academic year.
Annual Evaluation by Graduate Committee	Once an academic year.
BIMS Graduate Program Core Courses Completed	End of the sixth semester; (Fall 2021)
BIMS Curricular Track Required Course Completed	End of the sixth semester; (Fall 2021)
Residence Requirement	End of 4 semesters if no MS, 3 semesters if they have MS
Degree Plan Submitted	End of third long semester (Spring 2021)
Preliminary Exam	End of sixth to ninth semester (Fall 2021 - Fall 2022)
Research Proposal Submitted	End of sixth to ninth semester (Fall 2021 - Fall 2022)
First-Author Publication Accepted	End of ninth to twelfth semester (Fall 2022 - Fall 2023)
Research Presentation at a Conference	End of ninth to twelfth semester (Fall 2022 - Fall 2023)
Admitted to Candidacy	End of ninth to twelfth semester (Fall 2022 - Fall 2023)
Defense/Final Exam	End of twelfth semester (Fall 2023)
Apply to Graduate	End of twelfth semester (Fall 2023)
Dissertation Approval Form Submitted	End of twelfth semester (Fall 2023)
Copyright Form Submitted	End of twelfth semester (Fall 2023)
Dissertation Submitted	End of twelfth semester (Fall 2023)

Grad life - 1. Keep your progress on track

Project management APPs

e.g., Trello

Research – 2024 winter break

Papers:

- Chimei fault paper -> Journal of Structural Geology
[Reviewer feedback Jan 19]
First version of resubmission Feb 18
- Nankai HS experiments
Thin sections from the OCR tests
- Nankai HS friction manuscript

■ Left behind

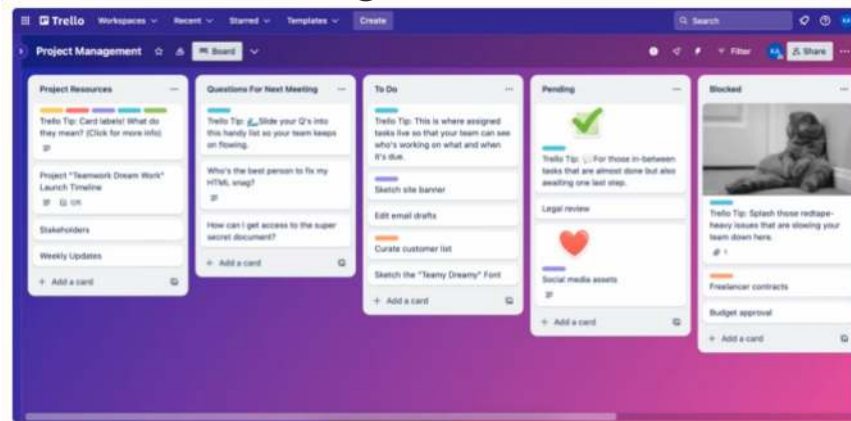
■ In progress

■ Failed

■ Done

New projects:

- LHVR leak test
 $\sigma_N = 12 \text{ MPa}$; $P_p = 10 \text{ MPa}$



筆記軟體 e.g., Logseq, Notion, ...

Specific challenges for grad students

1. Keep your progress on track
- 2. Relationships between you and your advisor(s)/colleagues**
3. Writing, presentation, or transferable skills
4. Teaching obligations or other part-time jobs

Grad life - 2. Advisors and colleagues

- **Advisors**

- They are not born to teach.
- **Power imbalance** (...abuse)

- **Advisors and Colleagues**

- Academic **misconduct** or unethical behaviors
- bullying
- Discriminations

PHD student in final year

Supervision
of supervisor

Final year PHD DEGREE

source: PhD memes



Jeff Darville · Follow

Ph.D. in Leadership and Organizational Management & Business Strategy, ... · Updated 5y

如何維持良好關係？

Related **What are some tips for getting along with your PhD supervisor?**

The way that I got along with my supervisor was being on task, on point, on time and open to feedback, correction and direction.

I understood the goal, to complete the dissertation and graduate. I did as much work as I could on my own before sending it in, posting it or requesting review. I completed summaries, outlines, mind-maps and presentations. I consistently emailed and I drove 4+ hours per w... [\(more\)](#)



Upvote · 18



James W. Hoover · Follow

History Professor in the U.S. (2001–present) · 3y

與期待不相符

Related **How can I deal with my "absent" PhD supervisor?**

This sounds like my Ph.D. supervisor. Quite often, he was *actually* absent - off traveling the world, with huge grants, for years at a time. However, when he was around he wasn't very useful, either, because he just straight-up didn't do his job. To make matters worse, he adopted extreme right-wing politics (for that time period) and began to make unnecessary and rather awkward attacks upon anyone in the field who espoused ideas he disagreed with

To deal with this precarious situation, I resorted to the following:

1. First, I had to see and accept that I was stuck with a lousy advisor, and that the

... [\(more\)](#)



Upvote · 20



Quora



Marcia McNutt · Follow

President at National Academy of Sciences · 4y

得不到認同

Related **What can you do if you feel you've done enough for a PhD but your supervisor disagrees?**

There are typically two reasons why your supervisor is preventing you from defending your thesis.

1. You are not ready to defend. In this case, your supervisor is doing you a favor. Consider this. Your time as a graduate student is one of the few times in your career when someone else is (usually) providing the funding for you to perform research in a thorough manner under the guidance of an experienced mentor. Take advantage of this opportunity. Learn all that you can, and build a solid resume.
2. Your supervisor is not ready to let you go. In some (very rare) instances I have heard of, a student has

... [\(more\)](#)



Upvote · 10



如何維持良好關係？



R K · Follow

11mo

Related **What are some things that a Ph.D. student should avoid doing with his/her supervisor in order to maintain a good relationship?**

There are many but few "strict NO" are given below:

1. Romantically Fall in love with the supervisor
2. With or without (1) above, have any sexual relationship. And it does not matters who initiates it.
3. Talking bad about other professors or students
4. Procrastinate on work.
5. Use profane language in front of supervisor.
6. Come drunk during the meeting.
7. Not having mutual respect and confidence on each other.
8. Talking bad about supervisors to other faculty members. The world is too small and he/she will know.

It is very common...



Ron Brown · [Follow](#)



Professor of Physics, Emeritus · 1y

Related **Is this common to have conflicts with your PhD advisor sometimes?**

Let's just say it's not *uncommon*. It wasn't exactly with my *formal* advisor, but rather with his 'underling', a professor in the research group that was a *de facto* advisor.

When Professor Lawson was hired by my university out of the Univ. of Chicago to build the graduate division when my campus was transitioning from an experimental under-grad only, limited enrollment college of letters and science to a full PhD granting university, he brought with him one of *his* recent PhDs as an assistant professor. (He was no Prof. Lawson, but tried to be.)

So it was this professor who most of the grad student... [\(more\)](#)



Quora



William Beeman · Follow



Professor and Chair, Department of Anthropology, University of Minnesota · Upvoted by... · 6y

Related **What are the primary causes of conflict between PhD advisors and their students?**

It is difficult being a graduate student, but it is even more difficult being a graduate advisor. For one, graduate students are adults, not teenagers. Their expectations are very high and they already see their friends functioning fully in an adult world with adult responsibilities (jobs, families, mortgages). But as graduate students they are still in training with low incomes for a very long ti... [\(more\)](#)

Upvote · 206



11



1



Ryan Rosario · Follow

Ph.D. in Machine Learning, University of California, Los Angeles (Graduated 2017) · 6y

Related **My PhD supervisor does not contribute to any ideas as he is not specialized in the field I am working on. Should I change my supervisor?**

Absolutely, if possible.

I just went through this. My first advisor was an amazing person and I really liked his philosophy of education and technology. He ran a series of centers and I was involved in one way or another in all of them. But, he had no interest in my field and I was not interested in the theoretical part of his work (just the practical). He was also close to retirement which added a whole slew of other issues. I was not making any progress whatsoever. I think he had been assuming that someone else was advising me because I was always a self-motivator. The entire time I worked wi... [\(more\)](#)



Upvote · 14



1



2



Quora

辨識



處理

換指導老師？

 **Aarti Narang** · Follow
Studied Neuroimmunology at Doctor of Philosophy Degrees (Graduated 2016) · Upvoted by Vedika Gupta, Doctor of philosophy Geography, Doctor of Philosophy Degrees (2025) · 5y

Related **What are some bad PhD supervisor characters?**

I can list a few based on my grad school experience

1. S/He always puts you down and undermines your progress and abilities instead of offering help or suggestions
2. They show no interest or care about your academic goals or development and are concerned about their output and their timelines
3. They don't inform you about the direction the lab is headed, major collaborations they have and or any patents/ tech transfer decisions they are making. As a lab director that's their responsibility to let the team know of the direction the lab is headed
4. Treating different members of the lab differently, showing favoritism and not have any set of rules that apply to all members equally
5. Not recruiting people to train you or not making the seniors that do train you be answerable
6. Not caring about your research goals and what you want to accomplish
7. All the meetings be " have you done this / that yet?" Instead of " how can I help you accomplish this "
8. Never appreciate how far you have come
9. Drown you in too many projects and tell you how you're slow since you haven't made progress in each one
10. Never see Raw data and help you interpret it but ask you to bring a publication quality product

×

11. Take every doubt you express about yourself or your data and use it against you
12. Fails to promote you amongst peers
13. Never nominates you for awards until you ask
14. Easily influenced by what others say and not have his own judgement
15. Sarcastically show you how you're unworthy of awards you're applying for
16. Never encourage you to apply for anything
17. Show surprise in your accomplishments
18. Insult you in your committee meetings
19. Delay your graduation date as much as humanely possible
20. Delay your reference letters for jobs
21. Not let you submit first author papers
22. Not give you credit in the form of authorship or patents or for grants you wrote for him
23. Exploit you and tell you it's not enough

Quora

辨識



Melinda Duncan · Follow
Professor at University of Delaware · 5y +

Related **How do I deal with a moody PhD supervisor?**

It depends on how moody and how far along you are in graduate school. Everyone can have bad days, however, advisors have the same range of behaviors as anyone else, and some can be so moody as to really affect your training since they run so hot and cold in their mentorship.

If you are in the first year or two, and are dealing with someone really out there, definitely consider finding another lab. ... [\(more\)](#)



Upvote · 5



...

處理

Ten Most Common Sources of Conflict Reported by International Graduate Students and Faculty Supervisors

期待落差

- 研究得不到幫助、回饋
- 不夠開放
- 缺乏有效溝通
- 對學生責任認知的差異

- 學生英文程度不好
- 無法溝通
- 不夠獨立

Sources of Conflict	International Graduate Students			Faculty Supervisors			χ^2
	Rank	n	%	Rank	n	%	
Lack of openness	1	18	32.0	9	10	18.9	2.03
Supervisor doesn't have enough time	2	16	29.1	10	9	17	1.60
Different expectations re: responsibilities of student and supervisor	3	15	27.3	8	12	22.6	0.11
Lack of feedback from supervisor	4	14	25.5	—	2	3.8	8.41**
Lack of support or guidance from supervisor	5	13	23.6	—	1	1.9	9.47**
Lack of communication	6	12	21.8	—	4	7.5	3.30
Different expectations re: closeness (personal) of relationship	7	11	20.0	—	3	5.7	3.73*
Different values re: important skills to develop in graduate training	8	11	20.0	7	12	22.6	0.01
Unclear conversation	9	11	20.0	6	15	28.3	0.61
Supervisor is disrespectful of student	10	9	16.4	—	0	0.0	9.46**
Student cannot write English adequately	—	5	9.1	1	28	52.8	22.32***
Student does not have adequate research skills	—	5	9.1	2	22	41.5	13.45***
Student cannot understand English adequately	—	4	7.3	3	20	37.7	12.78***
Student is too dependent on supervisor	—	3	5.5	4	17	32.1	10.97***
Student cannot speak English fluently	—	7	12.7	5	16	30.2	3.92*

Note: $df = 1$, $N = 108$; Yates's continuity correction is reported.

* $p < .05$. ** $p < .01$. *** $p < .001$.

Grad life - 2. Advisors and colleagues

- Advisors
 - They are not born to teach.
 - Power imbalance (...abuse)
- **Advisors and Colleagues**
 - Academic **misconduct** or unethical behaviors
 - bullying
 - Discriminations

Academic misconduct

學術不誠實一詞時常與學術不當行為（academic misconduct）、欺騙（cheating）、抄襲（plagiarism）、不實陳述（misrepresentation）、學術欺騙（academic fraud）等詞彙交互使用，雖然名稱不同，但意涵相似，都是指涉有關學生在學術活動中之不合倫理的行為。



臺灣學術倫理教育資源中心
Center for Taiwan Academic Research Ethics Education

<https://ethics.moe.edu.tw/>

Bully: a person who **habitually** seeks to **harm or intimidate** those whom they perceive as **vulnerable**.

Discrimination: the **unjust** or **prejudicial** treatment of different categories of people, especially on the grounds of ethnicity, age, sex, or disability.

Guidelines for doctoral students and supervisors on conflict management and change of supervisor

What to bear in mind during discussions

- 確認討論主題與目的
- 設定時間、避免冗長沒效率
- 注意對話禮節
- 列出可接受的選項
- 聚焦在能改變的事情、解決問題上
- 一定要有**第三方**加入

1. Identify the purpose of the discussion, be concrete about its content.
2. Agree on how long the discussion can take.
3. Hold the discussion in a neutral setting where you will not be disturbed (turn off all mobile phones).
4. Agree on basic principles.
 - a. Do not interrupt one another; let the person speaking finish.
 - b. Make an effort to understand one another; it is not about who is right or wrong – avoid arguing.
 - c. Deal with the issue at hand, rather than attacking the person.
 - d. Be factual and constructive, use only factual information.
5. Avoid verbosity.
6. What can you do to solve the problem? Focus on what you can change.
7. Express yourself in the first person and avoid any second-hand information.
8. Document progress:
 - a. What was the conversation about?
 - b. What agreements were reached?
 - c. Time considerations.
 - d. What decisions were taken?
9. Engage a third party. Although both parties involved may strive to collaborate, it can sometimes be hard to move forward. In that case, involving a third party can be helpful.

Grad life - 2. Advisors and colleagues



Texas A&M University
Graduate and
Professional School

- Department resources:
 - Graduate staff/faculty director(s)
 - Department Head
 - Academic Dean
- Ombuds services
- Division of Risk, Ethics and Compliance
- Title IX Office
- DEI Office/Committee
- Mentor system
- Research integrity committee
- Thesis advisory committee

Ombuds Services For Graduate and Professional Education

The Texas A&M University Graduate and Professional Student Ombuds Office serves as an **informal, independent, and neutral resource** that anyone from the graduate and professional community can use to obtain assistance with a **conflict, misunderstanding, concern or issue related to graduate education.**

Ombuds services in the US since the late 1960's:

https://www.ombudsassociation.org/assets/docs/JIOA_Articles/JIOA-2019-H.pdf

(pay attention to potential conflicts of interests)

Specific challenges for grad students

1. Keep your progress on track
2. Relationships between you and your advisor(s)/colleagues
- 3. Writing, presentation, or transferable skills**
4. Teaching obligations or other part-time jobs

Grad life - 3. Writing and presentation

- Writing studio: University Writing Center (UWC) or on-campus projects
- Language consultancy or language coach: Applied linguistics
- Transferable skills



Basic Writing Studio

The Basic Writing Studio focuses on providing tips and strategies to help you write more and frequently with less stress.

Sessions include:

- Tips,
- Suggestions,
- Motivators,
- Q&As, and
- Time devoted to writing.



Present well

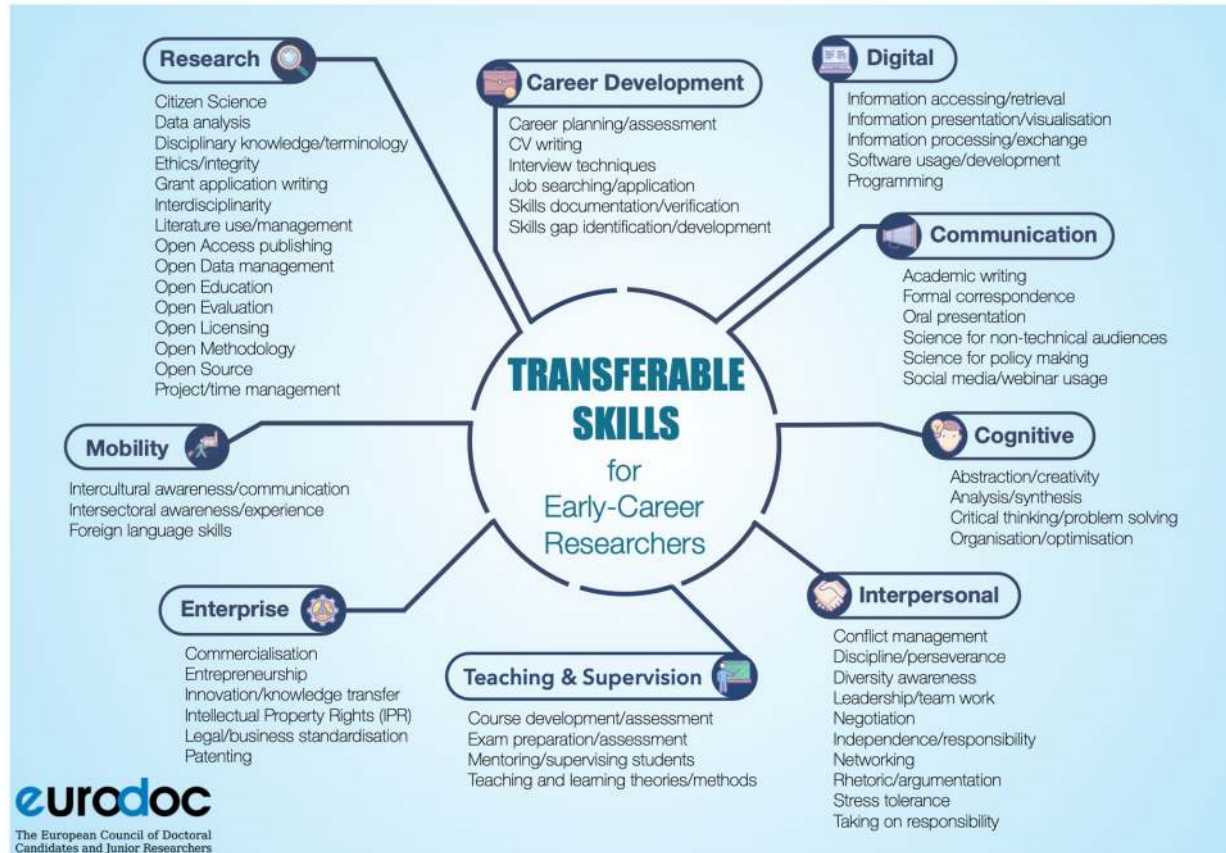


Mentor others



Advance your career

Grad life - 3. Transferable skills



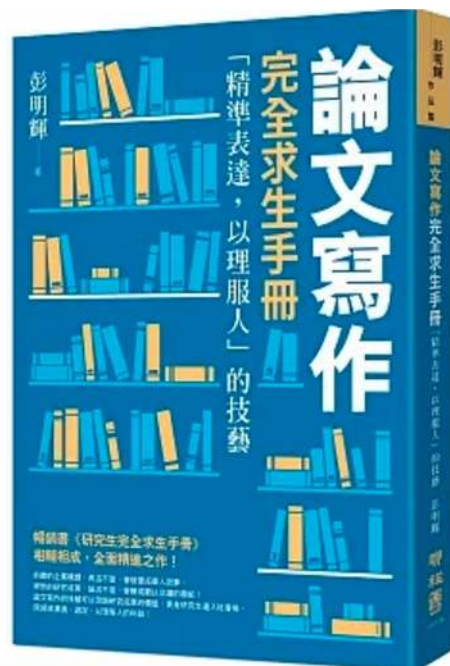
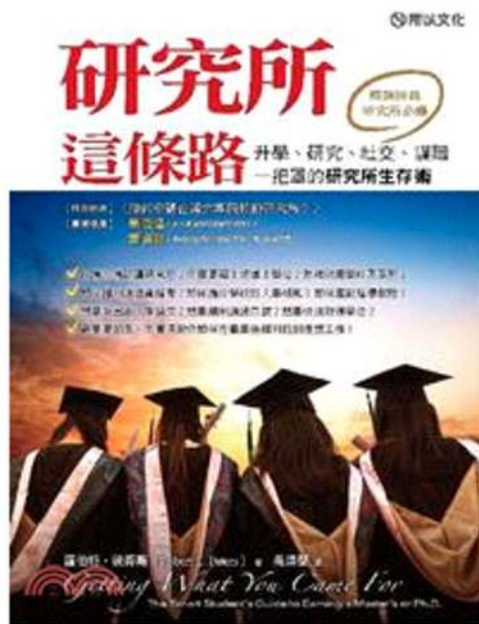
Specific challenges for grad students

1. Keep your progress on track
2. Relationships between you and your advisor(s)/colleagues
3. Writing, presentation, or transferable skills
4. **Teaching obligations or other part-time jobs**

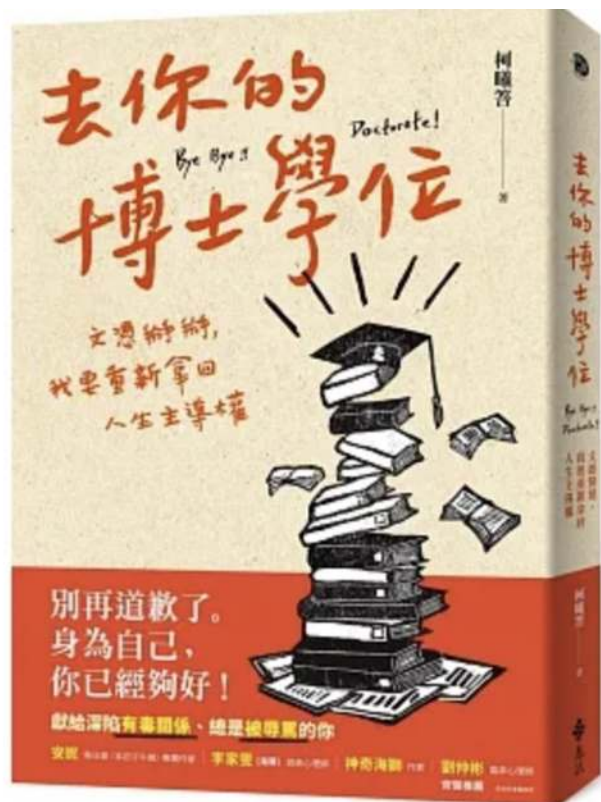
Grad life - 4. Teaching obligations or other part-time jobs

- Source of your funding/scholarship
 - TA
 - RA
 - External funding
 - MOE in Taiwan-Scholarship programs
- Internship, part-time jobs
 - ID qualification

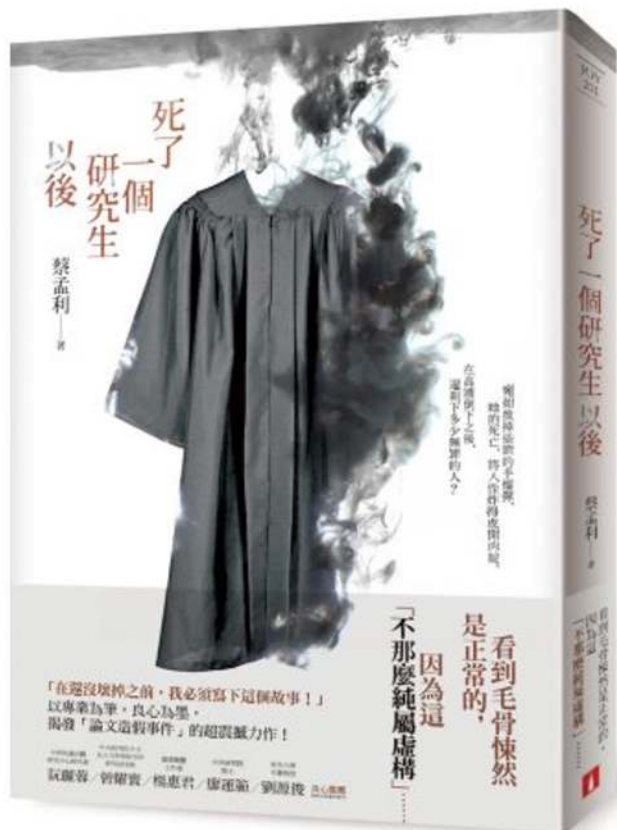
Other helpful resources



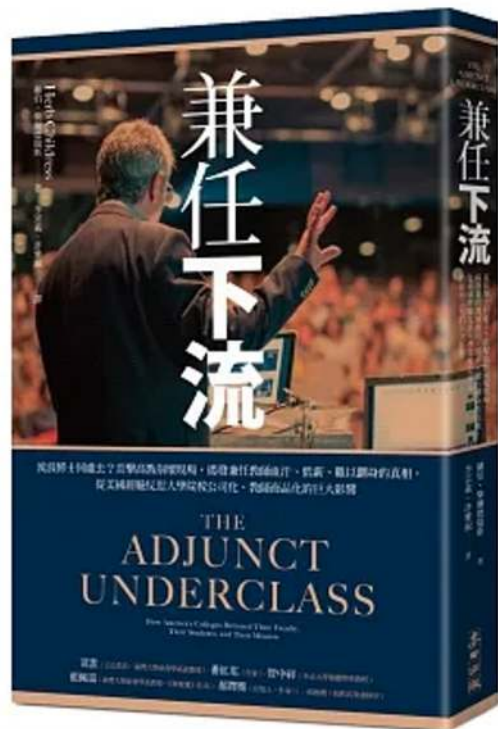
去你的博士學位：文憑掰掰，我要重新拿回人生主導權



死了一個研究生以後



面對離開學術界職業轉型的挑戰



Concluding remarks

- Your HEALTH and HAPPINESS are what really matter!
- Speak up and get HELP



Q&A: Conflicts

- 如果遭到同事排擠，教授無意處理該怎麼辦
- 很想知道不同國情之下，教授(老闆)對於研究生、博士生的工作要求與台灣的差異
- 如何面對國外行政效率都很慢 這件事情？
- 留學時如何提升抗壓能力。是否曾遇過情緒低潮，若曾有相關經驗，當時如何克服困難，或如何度過該時期。
- 有無遇過攻讀學位失利放棄；或被迫轉換學校系所再努力取得學位的案例。是否知道其如何調適，走出低谷？

Q&A: Finance

- 想請問老師，面對出國讀書經濟上問題，您當初是怎麼拿到這筆經費的？

Q&A: Time management

- 想知道留學生活不同面向佔的比重分配
- 課業 職涯 交友 旅遊 等時間規劃分配
- 請教如何在繁忙的學業與生活之間取得平衡，非常感謝！
- 想了解就讀博士期間是否有建議的兼職工作？
- 提及的資源是否適用於學期交換生

Q&A: Career

- 當初如何決定留學畢業後生涯發展(回國/續留海外)，能否分享當時的心路歷程，以及評估的方式。
- How to make connection with senior professionals and make good impressions, both in-person and LinkedIn cold call?
- 美國和新加坡尋找實習 工作 從學生簽證轉工作簽證經驗 如何建立當地有效人脈？

Q&A: Other specific questions

臺灣在德州農工的學生大概有多少人呢？德州農工對台灣學校還算熟悉嗎？入學初來乍到時可以尋找那些幫助來安定生活？

Texas A&M University - College Station is Extremely Popular With Taiwanese Students

An analysis of student visa data suggests that in 2020 as many as 22,079 Taiwanese students came to the U.S. to study at American colleges and universities. From this pool of 22,079, Texas A&M was home to approximately 135 Taiwanese students.

<https://www.collegefactual.com/colleges/texas-a-and-m-university-college-station/student-life/international/#modalTW>